

This might be a bug in the copy of the software with us alone but we don't recommend deliberately falling in trouble when you're not saving more than a few keystrokes. Once again, for the brave out there, you can experiment!

You can select the name of the virtual machine and the location of the files that will be created. You should either not change the default location, or in case you're changing it, make sure that you create a new empty directory for the purpose. Using a directory that already has files will cause disorganisation and make porting the virtual machine difficult.

Next, you get to select the size of the virtual hard disk. VMware Workstation tries to make a wise decision between the free space available and the recommended size for the guest OS you're installing. If you're going to only run MS word in Windows XP (let's suppose you're installing that) virtual machine that you're creating, allocating 40 GB won't be too wise. Also, do remember that VMware Workstation doesn't allocate all the size at one go (it used to till version 7).

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Allowing too much space in the beginning is not recommended if you don't need it. In cases as above, you can allocate 12-15 GB. If and when the space starts falling short, you can add another virtual hard disk later and make use of it using the guest OS (partition, format and mount it in the directory you need it).

You might choose to make the virtual hard disk into a single file or multiple files. If you need to port (copy or move to an external storage) the machine later on, go for the split files because a FAT32 partition (which most pen drives are formatted with normally) can't carry a single file any bigger than 4 GB, even if the media's total capacity is 32 GB. If you have an external hard disk which is formatted with a non-FAT32 file system, such as NTFS or Ext3 /Ext4, you can opt for the single file as well!



Figure 7: Easy install feature asks for Windows installation details